

Curium

96 Cm This radioactive element was named after the Polish-born chemist Marie Curie and her French husband, Pierre. Curium was discovered by American chemists Glenn T. Seaborg, Ralph A. James, and Albert Ghiorso in 1944. They produced the element in a cyclotron, a machine that smashes atoms into one another.



Marie Curie conducting an experiment in her laboratory

Californium

98 Cf Named after the state of California, californium was discovered in 1950 by the American scientists Stanley Thompson, Kenneth Street Jr., Albert Ghiorso, and Glenn T. Seaborg. This radioactive element is used in the treatment of cancer. It is also used in portable metal detectors.

Artificial creation

These pellets of californium were refined in a laboratory. The element is not found in nature and is created artificially by smashing atoms of berkelium with neutrons.



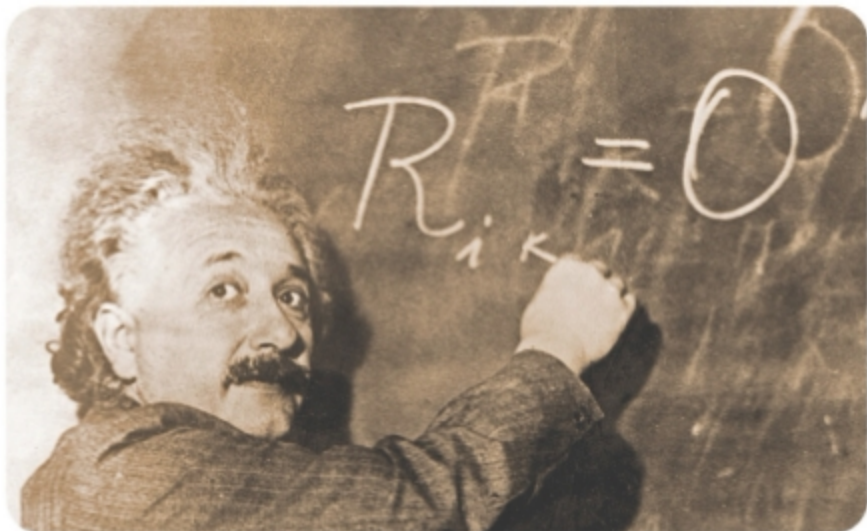
Pellets of radioactive californium

Berkelium

97 Bk This radioactive, silvery-white metal was named after the city of Berkeley in California, where it and several other elements were first made. In 1949, its discovery was led by a team of three American researchers—Glenn T. Seaborg, Stanley Thompson, and Albert Ghiorso. This element is so rare that it has no commercial or technological use today. In fact, only a little more than a gram of this soft element has been synthesized in the US since 1967.

Einsteinium

99 Es Discovered in 1952, this silvery, metallic element was named after the German-born physicist Albert Einstein. It was one of the two elements (along with fermium) to be identified while studying the remains of the "Ivy Mike" test—the first hydrogen bomb explosion.



Professor Albert Einstein